Abdullah Al Zahid

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October 13, 2026

Talent Acquisition
Capital Projects Group, Union Station Enhancement Project Office
Metrolinx, 130 Adelaide Street West, Toronto, ON

Re: Project Manager, Union Station Enhancement Project Office

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Project Manager position in the Union Station Enhancement Project Office. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and before that I was a Transportation Planner at Metrolinx in GO rail service design, working on the network that Union Station serves.

At the City I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, planning the work, holding the schedule and quality myself, and reporting progress to the people relying on it. I review the studies consultants and applicants submit against City standards and recommend conditions where something is missing, coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies, and write the briefing notes and presentations that carry issues and options to senior staff.

At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services and assessed what temporary and permanent slow orders would do to service. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. At Mott MacDonald I ran Synchro traffic simulations of Ontario Line construction staging and road closures.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not managed a capital infrastructure project through design, procurement, construction and commissioning, or run project controls, budgets, procurement, contract administration or commercial issues. I do not hold a PMP, C.E.T. or P.Eng., or a Class G licence, all of which the posting lists as assets. I am applying because the coordination, review and reporting parts of the role are what I do now.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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